

ASSERTION

STUDENT ACTIVITIES

Don't Be A Disser (michelleborba.com)

Skill Focus: recognizing bullying, put downs, standing up for self

Grade Level: K - 6

Description: Have the class look for ways people treat each other in TV shows. Do they put each other down and try to make each other feel stupid? Or are they kind and helpful toward each other? In what types of shows are they kind and helpful? The children could also look for role models of helping or put-down behavior in books or stories.

Know Your Helpers (goodcharacter.com)

Skill Focus: identifying helpers, getting/asking for help

Grade Level: K - 6

Description: Have the class work in small groups to brainstorm different kinds of help kids can get from others. Each group focuses on a particular group of helpers such as teachers, friends, siblings, or parents. Making a classroom bulletin board or posters showing different kinds of help and potential helpers could expand this activity.

Helping Buddies (goodcharacter.com)

Skill Focus: getting/asking for help, attempting work before asking staff

Grade Level: 4 - 6

Description: Divide the class into pairs of "helping buddies." Each buddy has two tasks: (1) decide on some knowledge or skill he or she would like to improve and (2) work with his or her buddy to improve the knowledge or skill-- or get the necessary help. The buddies meet regularly for a week or two and then report to the class on how they helped each other improve.

Puppet Skit or Role Play: Dealing with a Bully (teachablemoment.org)

Skill Focus: standing up for self

Grade Level: K - 3

Description: Write the word "bully" on the board. What's a bully? Elicit that a bully is a person who threatens other people (usually smaller than himself), sometimes hurting them and forcing them to do things they don't want to do.

Explain that the puppets are now going to act out a situation with a bully, and then the class is going to figure out how to deal with situation. Sometimes the best way to come up with a good idea is for a whole group to think about the problem and brainstorm solutions. As they say, two (or more) heads are better than one.

The puppet skit might go something like this:

Juan and Tyrone, first graders, are talking in a corner of the school playground about a fifth-grader named Robert.

Juan: I hate Robert!

Tyrone: Yes, he's really mean.

Juan: I just had to give him my candy. He said he'd beat me up after school if I didn't.

Tyrone: I know. Yesterday he told me he'd get me on the way home if I didn't give him my cookies from lunch. He thinks he's big and bad because he's in fifth grade.

Juan: Yes, and I don't like the way he bosses us around. Remember last week when we were in line for the drinking fountain and he cut right in front of us and pushed us out of the way?

Freeze the action at this point. What's going on here? After the students describe the situation, suggest that they brainstorm ways Juan and Tyrone could deal with the problem of Robert, the bully. Explain the rules of brainstorming: no comments on other people's ideas, the ideas don't have to be "realistic," go for as many ideas as possible in a short amount of time.

Discuss: Have you ever had an experience with a bully? What do you think of the ideas the class came up with? Could you see using any of them to deal with a real-life bully?

Quick Thinking: Standing Up Against Unfairness (role play)

(teachablemoment.org)

Skill Focus: standing up for self

Grade Level: K - 6

Description: Describe a problematic situation (like the ones below) to the class. Give the students, working in pairs, a minute or two to come up with an idea for addressing it the situation. Another option is work as a whole class. When the time is up, the pairs share their idea with the group. The aim is to generate lots of ideas and get people thinking, not necessarily to come up with the "best" approach.

Explain that the students will generate ideas for stopping people from treating each other unfairly. Here are some possible situations that you might suggest for "quick thinking":

- A group of boys is playing kickball. A girl asks to play and is told, "No! Girls aren't any good at basketball!"
- A boy is being teased because his hair is long. Other kids are teasing him saying, "He looks like a girl."
- Two girls are close friends and the other kids start to tease them, saying, "You're gay."

- A boy, who likes to read during recess and participates a lot in class, is teased by others who say, "He's a nerd!"
- A new girl, who just emigrated from another country, brings lunch from home that is different from everyone else's lunch. The other kids tease her saying, "Ick! She eats disgusting food!"

Afterwards, evaluate the workshop as a class. Ask students: What's one thing you learned in today's workshop? It's not easy to stop people when they're treating others unfairly. Can you see yourself using some of the ideas you came up with in "Quick Thinking"?

I-Messages and the Assertiveness Line (teachablemoment.org)

(By Amy Martin)

Skill Focus: standing up for self

Grade Level: K - 6

Description: Begin by writing "I-message" on the board. Explain that today the students will learn what an I-message is and how to construct one.

An I-message is a way to be strong, or assertive, without being mean when you are angry or upset or disappointed with something another person has done. The formula for an I-message is as follows:

I feel _____ (say your feeling)
 when you _____ (describe the action)
 because _____ (say why the action connects to your feeling)

The "I-message" is different from a "You-message." In a "You-message," you attack the other person, make judgments about him or her, and sometimes even call the person names.

For example, say the class is picking partners for an activity. You pick John, who wants to work with his best friend instead of with you. He lets you know by pouting and mumbling, "aaw!" You say, "You want to work with him? Fine! You're too stupid to work with me, anyway!"

Ask the class: How do you think John might feel about being called stupid? Will he be more or less likely to choose you as a partner in the future?

In this situation, what would an "I-message" be? Elicit possible "I-messages" from the students. (For example: "I feel disappointed when you always want to work with your best friend because I never get to spend time with you.")

I-Messages can also be used to express positive feelings. (For example, "I'm